Static Warning Banners Become Wallpaper

Current early intervention models fail because repetition induces habituation, while fear of surveillance prevents help-seeking.

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1. The Habituation Trap

Search banners sit passively alongside results without creating an intentional pause. Repeating the identical legal warning on every exposure creates instant sensory habituation — users scroll right past it.

0% Change

Ahmia trial (3.1M warnings over 140 days) found zero detectable reduction in searching behavior.

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2. The 73.9% Pre-Contact Drop-Off

Users don't abandon helplines because they lack a phone number — they drop out due to fear of the first 60 seconds: fear of police dispatch, fear of having to confess, and uncertainty about who will answer.

73.9% Abandons

Nearly three in four people who find a support service abandon before initiating any contact.

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3. The Surveillance & Adoption Trap

Users avoid reaching out when they suspect tracking. Concurrently, small long-tail forums and search providers refuse heavy moderation SDKs that harvest user PII or risk privacy liabilities under GDPR / DSA.

Zero Incentive

Long-tail platform operators lack adoption incentives, verifiable compliance credit, or differential privacy guarantees.

Empirical Challenge: Break the habituation cycle without resorting to punitive, easily bypassed blocks.

A Door, Not a Sign. And the Wall is Glass.

A human-centered early intervention framework combining behavioral de-escalation with verifiable zero-PII privacy.

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1. The Shift (Anti-Habituation)

Replaces static warnings with 5 sequential shapes tailored to user psychological needs:

#1	**The Gate**	Pauses results; Quick Exit
#2	**The Fork**	6 honest self-triage paths
#3	**The Wave**	90s urge-surfing & if-then plans
#4	**The Hallway**	De-risks call with scripts
#5	**Open Door**	Unconditional non-punitive presence

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2. The Glass Door (Zero-PII)

Privacy by construction, not by promise. Strictly refuses query text, client IP, cookies, and device fingerprints. Emits only an 8-field Counter schema:

```
{
  "i": "inst_001", // install ID
  "f": "wave", // shape shown
  "o": "help_click",// outcome
  "e": "3", "b": 16 // bucket & hour
}
```

✓ 100% auditable in F12 devtools
✓ 1-click localStorage wipe in widget

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3. The Desk (Operator Adoption)

Gamifies the platform operator rather than the vulnerable user:

- **The Open Door Ladder:** 5 verifiable criteria earning a public audit badge for EU DSA compliance reports.
- **k-Anonymity (k ≥ 10):** Any aggregate metric below 10 is automatically censored to prevent identifying individuals on small forums.
- **Stepped-Wedge Evaluation:** Scientifically tests Gate vs. Banner without randomizing users.

3-Line Integration

Installed by non-developers in under 15 minutes via a single lightweight script tag.